

35 Question words

Open questions are questions that do not have simple “yes” or “no” answers. In English, they are formed by using question words.

See also:

Forming questions **34**

Prepositions of time **107**

35.1 QUESTION WORDS

There are nine common question words in English.

What is used to ask questions about things.

What is the time?



When is used to ask questions about time.

When is dinner?



Why is used to ask for reasons.

Why are you mad?



Where is used to ask about places or directions.

Where is the café?



Who is used to ask about people.

Who is Jo's teacher?



Whom is a formal version of “who,” that can only be used as an object of a question.

Whom did you give the package to?



How is used to ask about a condition, or the way something is done.

How are you?



How can also be used with an adjective or an adverb to ask about the degree to which the adjective applies.

How busy is she?



Which is used to ask someone to specify between two or more named things.

Which car is yours?



Whose is used to ask who is the owner of something.

Whose cat is this?

